INCH-POUND

A-A-54893
23 July 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPES, STERILIZATION

Paper, Self-Sealing

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for MIL-E-36478B which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers disposable paper envelopes for use in holding hypodermic needles and dental syringes during autoclaving procedures.

Salient characteristics:

The envelopes shall be of the following types:

Type I — Envelope, sterilization, paper, self-sealing 3-5/8" L by 1-5/8" W by 3/4" D inches.

Type II — Envelope, sterilization paper, self-sealing, with pleated sides 7-7/8" L by 2-1/2" by 1-1/2" D inches.

The envelopes shall be designed and fabricated from paper of a quality and of a size suitable for use to hold dental cartridge syringes during sterilization and/or autoclaving procedures and to maintain sterility thereafter. Above dimensions shall be minimum values. The length (L) shall be measured with both flaps closed and the depth (D) shall be measured with sides expanded.

The envelopes shall be fabricated a fully bleached chemical wood pulp paper which is permeable enough to permit entrance of live steam for sterilization, and sufficiently impermeable after sterilization so that contamination from the atmosphere shall not enter into the closed envelope. The paper shall have the characteristics listed in table I, when tested herein.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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TABLE I. Characteristics of paper.

Characteristic	Unit	Required value
Basis weight	pounds	30 minimum
Moisture content	percent	3 to 7
Tear strength	grams	
Machine direction		40 minimum
Cross direction		40 minimum
Mullen strength (dry)	pounds per square inch	20 minimum
Tensile strength (dry)	pounds per inch of width	
Machine direction		20 minimum
Cross direction		10 minimum
Opacity	percent	65 minimum

The envelopes shall be the open-end type with the opening at one end only. The envelopes shall also be self-sealing type. The adhesive material shall be self-seal latex gumming which shall have a shelf life of not less than 36 months when stored in normal conditions of temperature and humidity. The adhesive material shall be applied to the open-end flap and the backside of the body of the envelope in strips so that when the open-end flap is closed, both adhesive strips shall join and permanently seal the syringe in the envelope. A spot or dab of adhesive material at these points shall not be acceptable. The adhesive material shall be the type that will only adhere to a similar composition adhesive material. The adhesive material shall withstand steam sterilization of not less than 250°F and a steam pressure of 15 pounds per square inch, for a minimum of 30 minutes per sterilization.

The open-end flap shall be of a size and design so that when it is folded over the body of the envelope it shall provide a safety fold of at least 3/16 inches across the entire width of the envelope.

The envelope shall be marked with a time-temperature-steam sensitive ink that will turn color under sterile conditions in autoclaving, thereby providing a visual indicator to show that the contents have been subjected to conditions of sterilization.

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The following printing shall be placed on the type II envelope only.

Syringe _____

Needle(s) _____

Other _____

_____

Date _____

Initials _____

The horizontal lines shall be placed at least 1/2 inch apart. The words "open this end" shall be printed on the upper flap of the envelope.

Inspection/delivery. The inspection/test dating period shall be 36 months. Not more than three months shall have elapsed from the date of manufacture of the envelope to the date of delivery to the Government.

Workmanship. The envelopes shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing 500 envelopes of the type, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination and tests. Sampling for examination and tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of envelopes.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Tests shall include, but shall not be limited to, the following:

Sterilization withstand test. The closed envelope with contents enclosed shall be capable of withstanding two successive sterilization cycles at 250°F/15 psi for 30 minutes, without deterioration of the envelope or of the adhesive, and without opening the envelope.

Sterility test. Twenty type I envelopes, each containing a spore strip impregnated with Bacillus Stearothermophilus, and a hypodermic needle (or twenty type II envelopes, each containing a similarly impregnated spore strip and a dental syringe) shall be properly sealed and sterilized once. Immediately after sterilization, the contents of ten envelopes shall be tested as specified below. The remaining ten envelopes shall be exposed to to the atmosphere at ambient temperature (18°C to 27°C) for 30 days and the contents shall then be tested as specified below. To test for sterility, aseptically transfer five of the needles and all ten of the spore strips to culture tubes containing fluid soybean casein digest. Incubate the needles at 20°C to 25°C and incubate the spore strips at 55°C to 65°C for not less than seven days. Transfer the five remaining needles to culture tubes containing fluid thioglycollate medium and incubate at 30°C to 35°C for not less than seven days. The quantity and preparation of the media shall be as described under sterility tests in the U.S.P.

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Dry heat test. Envelopes shall be placed in a dry heat oven for 30 minutes at 80°C plus or minus 3°C. The envelopes shall be removed and allowed to cool for 30 minutes and then examined for color change.

Physical characteristics of paper. Paper shall be tested in accordance with applicable method shown in table II and referenced in TAPPI testing procedures for compliance.

TABLE II. Tests for physical characteristics of paper.

Characteristic	TAPPI test procedure
Basis weight	T 410
Moisture content	T 412
Tear strength	T 414
Bursting (Mullen) strength	T 403
Tensile strength	T 404
Opacity	T 425

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document.

NSN	Item identification	Type
6530-00-299-8370	Envelope, Sterilization, Paper, Self Sealing, 500's	I
6530-00-754-0421	Envelope, Sterilization, Paper, Self Sealing, 500's	II

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Air Force - 03
Army - MD
Navy - MS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

FDA-MPQAS
USPHS
VA - OSS

Project Number: 6530-2258

Location: ENVEL19C.DOC

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I. RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER: A-A-54893	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD): 23 July 1993

3. DOCUMENT TITLE: ENVELOPES, STERILIZATION, Paper, Self-sealing

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME: DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER ATTN: DPSC-MSE	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial: AC 215-737-2870	(2) AUTOVON: AV 444-2870
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) 2800 SO. 20TH STREET PHILADELPHIA, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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